

The morning was cold and she walked the length of the garden without once looking back toward the quiet house where the others were still sleeping under heavy blankets. She had rehearsed the words for weeks and still they came out wrong whenever she tried to say them to anyone at all. There was frost on the grass and the light was very thin. Somewhere behind her a door opened and then closed again. She counted her steps to the gate and back, twice over. and so at last she stopped and consid-

ered what she might yet say to him before the day ended. The morning was cold and she walked the length of the garden without once looking back toward the quiet house where the others were still sleeping under heavy blankets. She had rehearsed the words for weeks and still they came out wrong whenever she tried to say them to anyone at all. There was frost on the grass and the light was very thin. Somewhere behind her a door opened and then closed again. She counted her steps to the gate and back, twice over.

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noon folded itself away without any of them noticing it. The morning was cold and she walked the length of the garden without once looking back toward the quiet house where the others were still sleeping under heavy blankets. She had rehearsed the words for weeks and still they came out wrong whenever she tried to say them to anyone at all. There was frost on the grass and the light was very thin. Somewhere behind her a door opened and then closed again. She counted her steps to the gate and back, twice over.

THREE: The Water

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